

HOW CEOs CAN SPEAK WITH CLARITY

• Navigating the current geopolitical scenario can be trying, but here are some tips that can help leaders avoid common pitfalls while communicating with the external world



Principles over Politics:

CEOs should focus on universal human values—safety, dignity, and fairness—rather than taking political sides.



Authenticity Builds Trust:

Consistent, empathetic communication earns more respect than performative or reactive statements.



CCO as Strategic Anchor:

Chief Communication Officers should lead the intersection of corporate affairs, geopolitical intelligence, and communication strategy to avoid fragmented messaging.



Ethics v/s Geopolitics:

While ethics are non-negotiable, geopolitical decisions demand nuance, awareness, and balance between sentiment and strategy.



Institutional Preparedness:

Firms should build internal mechanisms, appoint experienced advisors, and ensure leaders understand government relations and policy implications.



Speak with Restraint, Lead with Awareness:

CEOs must stay informed, align public statements with national sensitivities, and rely on expert counsel to protect reputation and continuity.

viewed as important in a leader's ability to balance contrarian views, i.e., taking difficult decisions while being diplomatic on tough geopolitical issues. Assessment focuses on whether the candidate has a mindset to handle challenges and change/disruption. Finally, cognisance is taken of the leader's moral compass on upholding principles."

The post-Covid world, he adds, has redefined what it means to be "CEO-ready."

"Boards expect leaders to manage uncertainty, mitigate reputational risk, and adopt sustainable, inclusive practices while still delivering quarterly results."

Political acuity, Medury argues, has become as critical as digital fluency. "It's the need of the hour, a blend of commercial rigour with socio-political awareness. Leaders must inspire multi-generational, diverse teams while harnessing younger, digitally

native talent."

Preparation, though, is everything. Geopolitical readiness should be treated as both communications discipline and continuity imperative. Build a purpose-led playbook in advance. Pre-clear positions on high-probability issues while engaging investors and regulators transparently is important to become ready for the top spot during turbulent times. **BT**